

Nickolas Diaz

Dr. Patrick Luck

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Response for Reconstruction

This discussion will talk about how demanding retribution from the victims of pre-civil war slaves cannot be achieved. From the text of “Jourdon Anderson Writes His Former Enslaver”, formerly enslaved Jourdon Anderson responds to his former master, Col. P.H. Anderson, who asked him to return to work on his Tennessee plantation. Writing back the former slave demands payment for the 30 plus years he has worked for free. There are a few problems with this retribution. First off from a former slave master, who only lost his slaves because it was forced on him, his morals do not allow him to feel guilty for his actions. A payment like this would require some sympathy from a person who is likely to never change their mind. Secondary in the text of “Mississippi Black Code”, tells of the result of the civil war, a series of laws were passed restricting the freedom of African Americans and forcing them back into labor, essentially replicating slavery. The very people that need to pay retributions are the same very people who are still causing damage, and creating even more victims. Even after the war has been resolved they keep pushing for what they believe deeply in their hearts. Retribution can’t work because the process of going from having slaves to treating them with respect is too long. It is a long process starting with stopping the damage, and then slowly teaching the population on a societal level the morals. And currently it is still on the stage of stopping the damage. When society has learned the morals, the people who caused the damage and the victims will have been gone, so at that point there is no point of retribution.